Reading C

Ayurveda



Suman was very happy that morning. She had rightly recognized some of the important herbs that her grandmother wanted her to bring from the backyard. Dadi had many little patches of the backyard where wild herbs were cared for. There were Lycopodium, Bhringraj and Aloevera. She liked the names and wanted to see how Dadi prepared medicines from the herbs.

"Dadi, we eat so many fruits and vegetables. But how do wild plants make medicines when some people say they are poisonous?"

All plants have some special features and medical science owes the cure of many chronic diseases to the plant kingdom. Nature opens itself to Ayurveda with a cure to the chemical and biological imbalance.

"Dadi, have you studied all about Ayurveda?" Suman asked.

"I will have to study the whole of Ayurveda all my life, I have only learnt a little till now."

"Will you tell me something about it?" Suman asked curiously.

There are several systems of medicine in the world. These mainly include: Allopathy, Homeopathy and Ayurveda. Allopathy is today the mainstream system of health care and treats the physical systems by using tried out medicines. Homeopathy is based on the doctrine of 'like cures like' whereby a substance that causes the symptoms of a disease in healthy people will cure similar symptoms in sick people. Ayurveda is the ancient Indian system of natural and holistic medicine. When translated from Sanskrit, Ayurveda means 'the science of life.' The Sanskrit root *ayur* means 'longevity' or 'life' and *veda* means 'science.'

While allopathic medicine tends to focus on the management of disease, Ayurveda provides us with the knowledge of how to prevent disease and how to eliminate its root cause if it does occur.

"How old is this science?" Suman looked into Dadi's wrinkled face.

"Quite old. The knowledge of Ayurveda was passed on orally for thousands of years through a lineage of sages in India until it was collated into a text," said Dadi smiling. "The oldest known texts on Ayurveda are the *Charaka Samhita*, *Sushruta Samhita*, and the Ashtanga Hrudaya. These texts detail the effect that the five elements found in the cosmic system – earth, water, air, fire, space – have on our individual system, and expound on the importance of keeping these elements balanced for a healthy and happy

life. Ayurveda places great importance on one's *pathya*, or lifestyle (eating habits and daily routine). Ayurveda also provides guidance on how to adjust our lifestyle based on the change of seasons. According to Ayurveda, each person will be influenced by certain elements more than others. This is because of their *prakriti,* or natural constitution. Ayurveda categorizes the different constitutions into three different doshas.

Yes, according to Ayurveda, each one of us has a unique mix of three mind/body principles which are responsible for our 'unique' physical, mental and emotional characteristics. These doshas are the 'governing principles' of 'Intelligence' that literally govern everything in the universe…and therefore each one of us…including you!"

"Dadi, what kind of doshas are they?" Wrong things? Suman tried to confirm.

The three doshas are known as Vata, Pitta, & Kapha. Understand these three doshas and how to influence them and you literally hold the reins of life in your hand. As the doshas govern 'everything,' if you know how to balance them, you can eliminate ill-health, create perfect balance and therefore enjoy ideal health…without any need for an external expert, doctor, guru or anyone or anything outside your own 'self'.

According to Ayurveda, everything consists of different proportions of five fundamental elements - space, air, fire, water and earth.

Vata is expressed as 'space and air' and is responsible for all 'communication and movement.' It's qualities are light, dry, changeable, quick, cold & subtle…like the 'wind.' Vata Dosha - the space and air - energy that controls bodily functions associated with motion, including blood circulation, breathing, blinking, and your heart beat. If kept in balance, it leads to creativity and vitality. When out of balance it produces fear and anxiety.'

"But Dadi, how is air, water, fire or earth felt in our bodies?" Suman looked confused.

"Listen carefully. Pitta is seen as fire and a little bit of water. Pitta governs all "energy and transformation" in our bodies and the universe. Its qualities are like fire - hot, intense, sharp, dynamic, sour/acidic, related to colour (red, orange, yellow etc). This is *the energy that controls* the body's metabolic systems, including digestion, absorption, nutrition, and your body's temperature in proper system it leads to contentment and intelligence. Losing balance can cause ulcers and anger.

Kapha is dominantly expressed as water and earth. As such it is almost the exact opposite of Vata dosha. It is heavy, slow, non-changing, sweet and moist/ oily. Kapha governs all 'structure and lubrication.' This is the energy that controls growth in the body. It supplies water to all body parts, moisturizes the skin, and maintains the immune system. It is expressed as love and forgiveness. Lacking in adjustment, it can lead to insecurity and envy".

Suman, it is interesting to know that people can be identified by their tendencies to the doshas. Dadi said, 'Whether you go to an allopathic, homeopathic or an ayurvedic doctor, you must always go to the professional doctor if you are not well. Taking any medicine without professional advice can be dangerous.'

Meanings in context

doctrine	:	a set of principles or beliefs
eliminate	:	to remove completely
cosmic system	:	belonging or related to universe
dominate	:	to be the most powerful or important
steadiness	:	not likely to change quickly
tendency	:	an unpleasant habit or action that keeps occurring

Comprehension

Answer the following questions.

1. What was the task given to Suman by her *dadi*?
2. Why did *dadi* need the herbs?
3. List the various systems of medicines prevalent in the world.
4. How are the three systems of medicine different from one another?
5. What are the basic principles of Ayurveda?
6. What effects do the five basic elements in the universe have on us?
7. What are the three energies (doshas)? List them.
8. How are people with *vata/pitta/kapha* different from one another in the functions of their body?
9. Name a well known person in your town who runs 'a health care centre'. Which system of medicine does he/she practice?

PZ3F9H

Vocabulary

I. Read the following sentences carefully and tick (✓) the correct meanings of the underlined words.

1. *Vata* people are very easy to <u>recognize</u>.
   (a) mix up (b) identify
   (c) to be friendly with (d) socialize
2. *Kapha* people are easy going and <u>relaxed</u>.
   (a) calm (b) social
   (c) open minded (d) talkative
3. *Pitta* people are very energetic and <u>organized</u>, warm and friendly.
   (a) well-planned (b) sincere
   (c) honest (d) lively
4. Usually one *dosha* or two are <u>dominant</u> in a person.
   (a) famous (b) powerful
   (c) exceptional (d) significant

II. Fill in the missing letters to form the correct spelling of the words.

1. _y_rv_d_ 2. D_m_n_nt
3. R_c_gn_z_ 4. B_l_nc_
5. M_xt_r_ 6. C_nf_d_nt

III. Circle the odd word out in the following sets of words.

1. ayurveda, homeopathy, allopathy, medicine
2. health, personality, diet, nutrition
3. organised, efficient, tidy, well-ordered
4. energetic, enthusiastic, tired, refreshing
5. aggressive, relaxed, calm, confident

IV. Find two words form the passage that are related to the words/pharses given below.

eg.: metabolism: circulation, breathing

a. *doshas* :
b. elements of nature :
c. system of medicine :

Grammar



Passives

Look at the sentences given below.

i. The chief guest ***was welcomed*** by the principal

ii. The library ***was arranged*** by the students.

The above sentences are in passive. In active voice, we can write these sentences as :

iii. The principal welcomed the chief guest

iv. The students arranged the library

In sentences (i) and (ii) the action is more important than the doer (Passive) whereas in sentences (iii) and (iv) doer is more important (Active)

Now, consider these sentences from the text:

a. The knowledge of Ayurveda ***was passed*** on orally for thousands of years throught a lineage of sages in India until it ***was collated*** into a text.

b. Dadi had many little patches of the backyard where wild herbs ***were cared for.***

c. Pitta ***is seen as*** fire and a little bit of water.

d. Kapha ***is*** dominantly ***expressed as*** water and earth.

- **A passive sentence begins with the person or thing that receives the action. It must have a passive verb.**

Passive sentence : The door was painted by Ashok yesterday.

Eg. : *Active sentence* : Ashok painted the door yesterday.

- **When we change a sentence from the active voice to the passive voice, the tense of the verbs has to remain the same.**

Eg. : Pitta governs all energy and transformation. *(active voice, present tense)*

All energy and transformation are governed by Pitta. *(passive voice, present tense)*

Tense	Active voice	Passive voice
Simple Present	main verb example : give	am/are/is + past participle of verb example : am given
Simple past	main verb example : gave	was/were + past participle of verb example was given
Present continuous	am/are/is + main verb with 'ing' example : is giving	am/are/is + being + past participle of verb example : is being given
Past continuous	was/were+main verb with 'ing' exmaple : were giving	was/were + being + past participal of verb example : were being given

- **When we change a sentence from the passive voice, we need to make sure the verb agrees with the subject in number.**

  Eg.: The sages describe the three *doshas* as *Vata, Pitta, & Kapha. (active)*

  The three *doshas are* described as *Vata, Pitta, & Kapha by sages. (passive)*

- **When we do not know who did the action or what was the cause of action, a passive sentence does not contain an agent.**

  Eg.: The documents have been checked.

  Present passive : eg.: Kapha ***is*** dominantly ***expressed as*** water and earth.

1. Put the verbs in brackets in correct form to complete the sentences.

a. Our neighbour, Mrs Singh, ... (accompany) us to the market every Saturday.

b. The small city ..... (illuminate) by thousands of multi-coloured lights at night during Navaratri.

c. It is a big factory. One thousand people..... (employ) here.

d. Most of the Earth's surface ..... (cover) by water.

2. These are some instructions from a computer operating manual.

i. Link up the monitor, keyboard and printer.

ii. Plug in the main cable.

iii. Switch on the monitor at the back.

iv. When the light appears on the screen, place the Day Disk in Drive A.

v. Push in the disk until the botton clicks out.
(It takes about 30 seconds for the computer to load the programme.)

vi. Press the Drive botton and the disk shoots out.

vii. Replace the Day Disk with the Document Disk.

viii. Press function key 7.

ix. Start work!

- **Change the instructions into present passive by filling in the blanks.**

  First the monitor keyboard and printer are linked up. Then the _____ is _____. The monitor is _____ at the back. When the light \ appears on the screen _____ in Drive A. The disk is _____ until the _____. About 30 seconds _____ by computer to load the programm. The drive button _____ and the disk shoots out. The Day Disk _____ with the Documents Disk. Finally the function key _____ . The word processor is then ready to use.

Writing

I. Read the information given in the table on the next page. Now write a descriptive paragraph about each of the following.

Vata, Pitta, Kapha.

A descriptive paragraph of *Vata* people is given here.

'Vata' people are imaginative persons. They often get excited by things. They forget things quickly. For them, making a decision is difficult. They often get worried. Physically, they do not put on weight easily. Often they have cold hands and feet and dry skin. They often find it hard to sleep. They walk quickly and talk a lot.

Vata	Pitta	Kapha
Often get excited by things	Like to have an organized life	Calm, relaxed person
Do not put on weight easily	Become angry easily	Gain weight quickly but lose it slowly
Learn quickly but forget quickly	Have a good appetite	Tend to walk slowly
Often have cold hands and feet	Like ice-cold drinks	Like to get up late
Like to talk	Do not like spicy food like Chillies	Learn slowly but remember well
An imaginative person	Critical of oneself and others	Do not like cool, wet weather
Often have dry skin	Often feel too hot	Feet tired after eating
Making decision is difficult	Have a good appetite	Eat slowly
Walk quickly	Often impatient	Do not get angry easily
Often find it hard to sleep	Become tired in hot weather	Kind, friendly person

II 'Get - well card'

Your friend is not coming to school due to some illness. Here is an example of a 'Get-well card' for her.

😐

24th July 2015

Dear Anu,

We are sorry to hear that you are not feeling well. We all miss you, especially in the Maths class. We hope you will be back to school soon. Take a healthy diet and cooperate with your parents.

Best wishes,

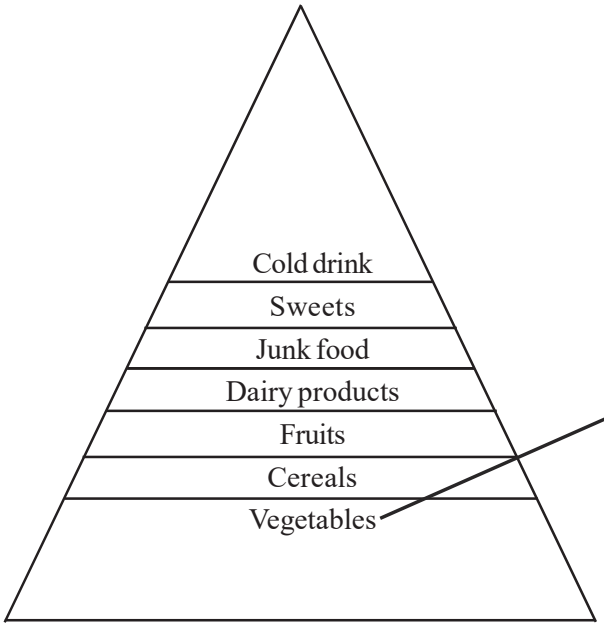
Ravi, Pooja, Kaneez and Kamal

Write a 'Get-well card' for another classmate who has been confined to bed for nearly two weeks.

You may get some help from the sentences given in the box.

We are sorry to hear that/about ————————
You have a cold/stomachache/headache/fever.
We are sorry to hear about ……..
Your broken arm/leg/accident
We hope that…….
You will be better soon/will be back at school/soon/will be out of hospital soon.
You should ……..
Take rest/follow the instructions of the Doctor/take medicine in time/take healthy diet/ cooperate with the parents.

III. Look at the following food pyramid and the food categories given below.



Food items
Chocolates, sweets, sugar
Burger, chips, kurkure, pizza/samosa
Butter, cheese, milk
Onion, potato, tomato,
Apple, banana, orange, mango
Bread, pasta, rice, pulse
Coco-cola, Pepsi, Miranda, Fruity, Thumps up

Food pyramid **Food items**

1. Match the food items in the box with the food categories in the pyramid.
2. Based on the food items listed by you in the food pyramid, write a brief description of your food habits.

Project Work

Look at the chart indicating the kind of food good for '*Vata*' '*Pitta*' and '*Kapha*' people. Observe three of your friends and write about their personality. Also suggest the kind of 'food' that is good for each of them.

Vata	Pitta	Kapha
Good Warm food and drinks sweet, sour and salty tastes, spicy and oily food, small, frequent meals	**Good** Cool food and drinks, sweet tastes, regular meal times, vegetables and salads	**Good** Warm food and drinks, bitter tastes, light meals, salads and soups
Bad Cold foods, raw vegetables and iced drinks, heavy and infrequent meals	**Bad** Sour and salty tastes, irregular meal time and quick snacks	**Bad** Cool food and drinks, sweet and sour and salty tastes, snacks between meals
Danger foods • Spinach, potatoes, peppers mushrooms, tomatoes, aubergines • Apples • All dried fruits • Curd, pickles • White sugar	**Danger foods** • Tomatoes • Bananas • Oils • Seafoods • Hot spices, salt, garlic	**Danger foods** • Tomatoes, potatoes • Very juicy fruits • Milk, cheese, yoghurt • Fried food, oily food • Sugar and all sweets except honey

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